

Theme	Code	What was affirmed	What was questioned	What was suggested	Expert interviews (supporting)	DiAmíti (supporting)	Interpretation	
Framework Validation	Framework first impression	Most experts reacted positively framework seen as filling a real gap, acting as an eye opener and conversation starter. E1,E2: "Provoke thinking". *DiAmiti found it novel and motivating.	E2, E5 noted it feels overwhelming. E8 warned of risk of guiding teams incorrectly.	Simplify entry point. Add onboarding overview before full framework. Allow jumping to specific stages (E2, E8).	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7, E8,E9	D1, D2	Framework helps startups reflect on technology necessity and design choices (E6: is AI actually needed?). Encouraging deeper reflection beyond initial assumptions. Different navigation and UI approaches should be considered to reduce overwhelm for very early-stage startups.	

Framework Validation	Problem-gap confirmation	All experts confirmed the gap: startups lack structured tools to integrate sustainability, accessibility, and AIoT. AI is often used due to trends rather than necessity (E5, E6). DiAmíti confirmed from lived experience. E9: Noted impact startup founders often have blind spots: "so convinced their ideas can only do good." Early-stage startups "rarely pay attention" to sustainability frameworks as they are "scrambling to do other things."	E8: political/regulatory uncertainty makes sustainability a moving target. E3: sustainability gets deprioritised under financial pressure.	Explicitly acknowledge the survival-vs-sustainability tension within the framework (E8).	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7, E8,E9	D1, D2	The problem is validated by both expert knowledge and lived startup experience. However, regulatory uncertainty and financial pressure are real contextual factors the framework cannot solve alone. It can, however, make these tensions visible and help startups navigate them consciously.	
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Framework Validation	Overall relevance rating	Average expert score: 4.5/5. DiAmíti average: 4.3/5. High consensus on relevance for early-stage impact tech startup.	E4 scored 3.5 /5 — needs more practical how-to guidance. E8: 5/5 in ideal conditions; 2/5 in survival-mode conditions. E9: Acknowledged relevance may vary by stage and that highly survival-focused startups may set it aside temporarily.	Add a minimum viable entry point for survival-stage startups. Consider conditional pathways based on startup maturity.	E1(5), E2(5), E3(5), E4(3.5), E5(5), E6(4), E7(4), E8: 5/5 ideal / 2/5 survival-mode, E9(4)	P1: 4, P2: 4, P3: 5	High and consistent relevance scores across both sources confirm framework value. The main barrier is not content relevance but information volume and terminology accessibility. E8's dual score reveals an important design requirement: the framework needs a lighter entry version for startups in survival mode.	
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Framework Validation	Concrete decision changed	DiAmíti changed their service model for the prosthesis. Reconsidered stakeholder mapping and shifted material priorities after using the framework.	-	-	-	D1	Direct evidence of the framework's decision-making utility. The service model shift — from selling a prosthesis to a maintenance and retention model — is substantive, not cosmetic. This is the strongest indicator that the framework changes how startups think, not just what they know.	Pointing piut what aso they have done right like the stakeholder engagement.
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Framework Validation	Hidden assumption surfacing	DiAmíti surfaced the assumption that users prefer bionic over conventional prosthetics. SDG alignment forced team to articulate and debate shared goals for the first time. E7:"Customer needs thinking on the desirable, feasible and viability... does this product is actually needed?" ,”Is this solving real human problems? before assessing impact" E9:mpact startup founders: they were "so convinced their ideas can only do good" that they had blind spots they did not want to examine.	Not directly tested in expert interviews but experts inferred this function rather than experiencing it.	Make assumption-surfacing function explicit in framework guidance materials.	E7	D1	The framework enables deeper reflection on impact by making implicit assumptions explicit. The team moved away from vague impact statements toward specific, debated goals. This validates the SDG dimension's utility at Stage 1 and supports the anticipation principle of Responsible Innovation.	
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Framework Validation	Risk identification	DiAmíti identified AIoT integration risks and circular economy regulatory risks not previously considered (e. g. municipal regulations on electronic waste). E9: "AI sustainability risks not typically considered by startups: LLM energy consumption, water usage, and provider opacity. "	Two evaluation approaches create tension: Two evaluation approaches create tension: Process sustainability (operations, travel, materials) Product impact sustainability (final solution addressing problems) Example: Sustainable packaging company with unsustainable sales travel Reality check: Metal sourcing costs killed sustainable product idea	Add risk prompts more explicitly to AIoT and Environmental dimensions that can guide them.	E9, E3	D1	Framework exposed material and regulatory blind spots For example, including PLA toxicity and waste regulation that had not been on the startup's radar. This confirms the risk-surfacing function and supports the case for including explicit risk prompts in future iterations.	
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Framework Validation	Framework positioning	Interviewers considered it a strategic tool that provoke thinking and conversation starter. DiAmíti experienced it as a strategic thinking tool, not a checklist, but when checking questions one by one felt like it. They would use it again. Responsible Innovation lens was a surprise positive (DiAmíti had not encountered it before).	E8: risk of becoming a distraction from core business priorities. E8: framework currently too broad for a specific user group.	Clarify in positioning materials that this is a thinking aid, not a compliance tool. Consider a starter kit version with a reduced question set (E8).	E6 (explicitly mentioned strategic value)	D2	The non-checklist effect is a key strength: the framework prompted strategic dialogue rather than box-ticking. However, the absence of clear progress markers was noted as a gap. Future iterations should include lightweight progress indicators to give users a sense of advancement without turning it into a compliance tool.	
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Framework Structure	Dimension structure	Five dimensions seen as well-structured and complementary. SDG, Environmental, and Accessibility dimensions cover social aspects effectively (E3). DiAmíti: all dimensions integral and aligned with design principles.	E3:SDG alignment appropriate but needs narrowing guidance – E3 E4:Clear and natural E9:Raised SDG framework validity as the key conceptual gap: questioned whether SDGs remain a valid reference given political erosion (missed 2030 targets, legislative rollbacks).	Add a brief what this dimension covers to clarify boundaries.	E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7, E8	D2	Overall five dimensions are relevant and important. A clear scope statement per dimension would help users understand each one's focus and reduce perceived overlap. This is a low-cost improvement with high usability impact.	
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Framework Structure	Dimension overlap	While the expert evaluation did not identify any critical inconsistencies regarding the overlapping elements, it highlighted a need for greater clarity in the framework's guidance. Overlap reflects the interconnected reality of sustainability, accessibility, and technology.	E4: overlap exists but dimensions remain natural. E9,E5:Noted that SDG Alignment and Environmental Sustainability could feel repetitive to users, but did not consider this fatal. DiAmíti: RI sub-structure within dimensions created cognitive overload;	Explicitly acknowledge that overlap is intentional. To enhance clarity, experts recommended a strategic choice: further condensing the questions for efficiency or providing detailed justifications to distinguish between overlapping thematic areas Explain the RI lens as the unifying logic in an introduction note.	E4, E5,E9	D1	Overlap between dimensions is an inherent feature of a unified framework, not a design flaw. The key is to frame it as intentional integration rather than duplication. The RI sub-structure, while conceptually sound, needs to be embedded more invisibly so users experience it as coherent flow rather than redundancy.	
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Framework Structure	Dimension prioritization	No consensus on a universal priority order highly context (core values and goals of startups). Context dependent. SDG Alignment is the natural starting point for impact-driven startups (E6). DiAmíti shifted prioritisation toward some dimension after working through the framework. The team had different opinion.	E4, E6: debate on whether framework targets first-time founders or experienced ones affects which dimensions feel most relevant.	Make dimension order flexible. Allow startups to enter at their most relevant dimension rather than requiring sequential progression.	E6, E7, E8	D2 (dimension prioritisation exercise)	There is no single correct dimension order as it depends on the context, sector, and startup maturity. All influence what matters most at a given moment. The framework's modular design should be made explicit so users feel empowered to navigate non-linearly rather than feeling obliged to complete every dimension sequentially.	
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Framework Structure	Product Development Lifecycle stage gaps	E6: stages mirror proven accelerator programmes methodology. DiAmíti: stage order is logical and aligns with how the startup evolves. Stage 5 iteration emphasis affirmed as important. E9: reads as too linear - "could be read a bit like the waterfall approach."	E1: missing stage for post-launch/shipping considerations. DiAmíti: market launch moment is ambiguous; Stage 5 and 6 boundary unclear.	Add clarity on when the product goes to market definitively. Consider a post-launch reflection sub-stage. Audit each stage for skill-level assumptions. E9: Suggested making feedback loops between stages more explicit.	E1, E6, E9	D2	Stage logic is validated as realistic by a startup actually in early stages, an important confirmation. The main structural gap is at the Stage 5/6 boundary: the transition from deployment to evaluation to iteration needs clearer demarcation so startups know when they have moved from one phase to the next.	
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Framework Structure	Framework gaps	Multiple experts and DiAmíti identified missing financial and economic depth as the top gap , strong convergence across both sources.	E6, E8: investment readiness and revenue generation underemphasised. E3: materiality assessment missing. E7: desirability and human needs assessment missing. E5: team culture, mental health, and founder conflict resolution absent. DiAmíti: cost structure, regulations, country context, and organisational structure missing.	Add financial viability prompts under Startup Viability. Add country/regulatory context note. Add a glossary for technical and conceptual terms. E8: consider involving impact investors in future iterations to add their perspective.	E1, E3, E5, E6, E7, E8	D2	The convergence between expert and DiAmíti feedback on financial depth is the most robust finding in this theme. Multiple dimensions could be added or expanded, but given the framework's resource-constrained target audience, additions should be prioritised by their practical impact for early-stage startups rather than theoretical completeness.	
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Framework Structure	Framework structure friction RI	RI sub-structure within each dimension is the primary structural friction point, confirmed by both experts and DiAmíti. At the same time, RI principles were described as the most inspiring element once understood at overview level.	DiAmíti found RI layering overwhelming and felt they were not advancing. E8: some questions are premature for their lifecycle stage.	Embed RI logic invisibly rather than surfacing it as explicit sub-categories in each dimension. Users should experience the RI principles through the questions without needing to navigate them as a separate layer. Suggested doughnut economics/planetary boundaries as a more scientifically grounded alternative.	E2, E7, E8,E9	D1	This is the most actionable structural finding. The RI framework adds intellectual rigour and is valued when understood at the conceptual level but its current presentation as a visible sub-structure within each dimension creates cognitive overload. The solution is not to remove RI but to redesign how it is presented: embedded in the questions rather than labelled above them. Questions should be reviewed to have better connection with the product development lifecycle.
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Usability & Applicability	Question quality	Majority affirmed questions are meaningful, well-scoped, and not overly abstract. E1: overall level is really meaningful. E9: Noted some questions feel "a bit arbitrary" as to which stage they appear in: "you could swap them around and you would not really know the difference." DiAmíti: questions are pointed; probes help clarify what each question refers to. Responsiveness questions were too abstract.	E6: some yes/no questions should be converted to open-ended reflection prompts. E4: unclear target skill level affects question. A first-time founder might not understand certain questions, but an experienced founder might find them too basic. E2, E7: some questions too abstract without sufficient contextual guidance. E9: "questions vary enormously in depth - some can be discussed in 5-10 minutes, others "could be a workshop in itself."	Convert yes/no questions to reflective prompts. Audit questions for stage-appropriate timing. Add a glossary for technical terms (intergenerational divide, digital divide, AI logs).	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7, E8, E9	D2	Question quality is broadly affirmed, but terminology / jargons used is a concrete barrier. Terms like intergenerational divide, digital divide, and AI logs were not understood. A glossary is a low-cost, high-impact improvement. Converting yes/no questions to reflective prompts would also increase the depth of engagement without increasing cognitive load.	
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Usability & Applicability	Format and delivery	Strong consensus: facilitated workshop format preferred over self-guided use. Digital tracking tool consistently suggested by multiple experts. E1, E8: preference for automated, interactive formats.	No expert suggested the current static framework format is sufficient as a standalone tool. DiAmíti: virtual navigation amplified cognitive overload during sessions.	Develop a facilitated workshop guide with stage-specific sessions. Build a digital companion tool with progress tracking. Create a short onboarding video or guideline. Consider AI agent format to prevent teams getting stuck (E1, E4, E8). Add a baseline score or impact metric (E2, E6). E9: branching/type form-style interface - ask "which stage are you at?" and surface only relevant questions.	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7, E8	D2	This is the most consistent finding across all sources. The framework content is valued, but the delivery mechanism is the primary usability barrier. Multiple concrete formats emerged: workshops, digital tools, AI agents, scoring systems. Reflecting different user contexts and preferences. The implication is that the framework needs a deployment strategy, not just a content refinement.	
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Usability & Applicability	Target users	Consensus: founders and key team members, not the whole organisation. Solo founder use is also valid. E6: accelerator programmes, university hubs, and innovation ecosystems are strong deployment contexts. DiAmíti: key people first, then share with the wider team.	E7: impact-driven startups most receptive but tech-focused startups would benefit most. E4: AI-heavy startups are the primary target.	Define primary and secondary target user profiles in the framework introduction. Consider separate entry points for different user types (solo founder vs. team vs. accelerator cohort).	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7	D2	The target user profile is broader than originally scoped extending to academic, consulting, and accelerator contexts beyond just impact tech startups. This creates an opportunity to position the framework as an ecosystem tool, not only a founder tool. However, broadening scope too early risks losing the specificity that makes it valuable for resource-constrained startups.	
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Usability & Applicability	Optimal lifecycle timing	Majority: most valuable at early stage, pre-seed, or before building begins. E5: useful throughout the entire lifecycle. DiAmíti: most valuable at early stage; planning phase alone can take 4–6 months.	E4: also valuable post-MVP when rebuilding product architecture. E7: Early startup lifecycle before strategy or the culture formation because is harder to change in mid-stage.	Create a when to use this framework guide with clear entry points for different startup stages. Adapt to monthly working timelines to match real startup planning cycles.	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, E7, E8	D2	Early stage is confirmed as the primary use case by both experts and DiAmíti. However, the framework has longitudinal potential. DiAmíti's observation that planning can take 4–6 months suggests the framework should be designed for sustained use over time, not a single workshop moment. This has implications for how the digital tool and workshop guide should be structured.	
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Competitive Landscape	Existing alternatives	Most of the experts referenced design thinking, lean startup, and SDG checklists as the closest existing tools. No expert was aware of a unified framework integrating all five dimensions for early-stage startups. DiAmíti uses lean startup methodology.	Existing tools address one dimension at a time, but none integrate sustainability, accessibility, and AIoT together for early-stage, resource-constrained startups.	Position the framework explicitly as complementary to lean startup and design thinking but not a replacement. Identify how framework outputs can feed into existing tools (e.g. lean canvas, business model canvas). E9: compared it favorably to Marty Cagan's product framework (desirability/usability/feasibility/viability/ethicality).	E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6,E9	D2	Confirmed uniqueness of the framework within the existing landscape. The absence of a comparable integrated tool validates the research gap identified in the literature review. Positioning as complementary rather than competitive will reduce adoption friction. Startups already using lean startup methodology can layer this framework on top of their existing practice.	
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